

RESTORING A SESSION AFTER BROWSER CRASH

You've got 20+ tabs open. You revel in your "Geek - Level 9" status. Browser crashes... FFFUUU! If you too are regularly haunted by the nightmare of losing the hours of effort put in opening all those tabs due to sudden crashes, these tips are sure to bring a big sigh of relief. A few useful plug-ins and slight changes in your settings could be just the thing you're looking for.

Extensions for Chrome

For Chrome users, in most cases when you reopen the application after a crash, it automatically prompts you to return to the last session (with a sorry face, mind you!), and simply pressing the Restore button will take you back to all the tabs and windows you had open initially. But extensions like FreshStart, Sessions Manager and Sessions Buddy add another level of functionality. With FreshStart you can choose which tabs to save across all the open windows, to be stored under a particular session. Sessions Buddy captures your last 10 most recent sessions, an especially helpful feature after a browser or system crash. On starting the browser again returning to a particular session is a breeze.

Mozilla Firefox add-ons

Firefox also prompts you when you restart the browser after crash, and clicking on the Restore Session option will

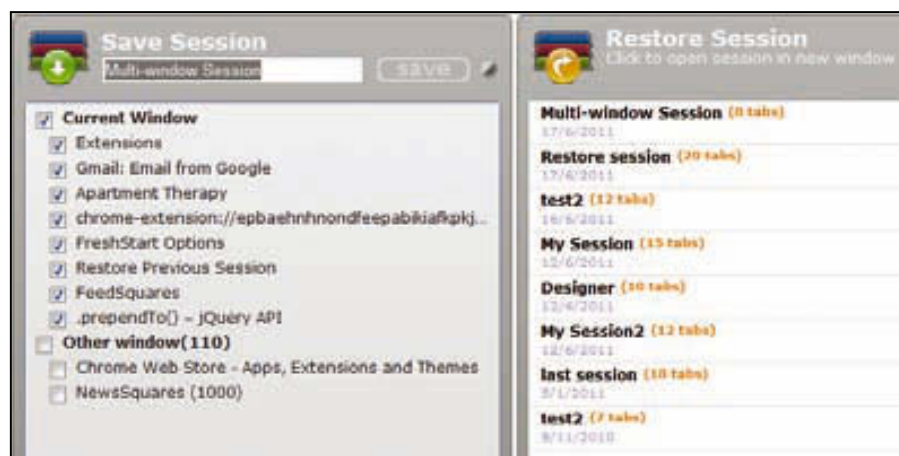
reopen all tabs and windows. But as with Chrome, add-ons give you much more control. Open <https://addons.mozilla.org/> and search for Sessions Manager. It can also automatically save the state of open windows individually. Other common add-ons for this purpose are Tab Mix Plus, which also includes a full-feature manager with crash recovery that can save and restore a combination of opened tabs and windows and save session.

Tweaks for IE

If your Internet Explorer crashes or shuts down for whatever reason, when you reopen the application and go to "about: Tabs", there's an in-built link on the bottom of this page to reopen your last session as it was. Opening a prior session is tricky though. The solution is to install a separate application for this, the most popular being the IE Sessions Manager (download from <http://bit.ly/GFtJqC>)



Feature in IE9 to reopen tabs after crash



FreshStart extension in Chrome to organise sessions via Chrome Store



REVEAL A PASSWORD FROM ASTERISKS (*****)

Suppose you've forgotten a password to a particular login, but it still appears via the auto-fill utility. Copying the bullets/asterisks and pasting them into an empty text file won't help out in anyway. So in these instances you need to extract your password that's hiding behind *****. One way to do this is by using a software that does it all. We came across one particular site (http://www.nirsoft.net/password_recovery_tools.html) that offered interesting tools.

BulletsPassView, for instance, converts passwords it encounters in open programs. There's even a program which can analyse your router settings backup file to show you your password.

For web sites, if you'd like to check your password one last time before pressing enter, you could use a Greasemonkey script. You'll have to get the Greasemonkey add-on installed first, then navigate to <http://dgit.in/GFC61I>. Click the green



Use Greasemonkey scripts

Install button in the top-right corner of the web page. All you need to do now is mouse-over the password box and your password will be changed to plain text as long as the cursor is within the box's boundaries. We've listed the script at the web site given above, just in case you're wary of installing unknown scripts from the web. **[1]**